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Acer tataricum

Acer tataricum, the **Tatar maple** or **Tatarian maple**, is a species of maple widespread across central and southeastern Europe and temperate Asia, from Austria and Turkey east as far as Japan and the Russian Far East. The species is named after the Tatar peoples of southern Russia; the tree's name is similarly commonly also misspelled "Tartar" or "Tartarian" in English.[3][4]

Acer tataricum
Foliage and fruit
Conservation status
Least Concern (IUCN 3.1)[1]
Scientific classification
Kingdom: Plantae
Clade: Tracheophytes
Clade: Angiosperms
Clade: Eudicots
Clade: Rosids
Order: Sapindales
Family: Sapindaceae
Genus: *Acer*
Section: *Acer* sect. *Ginnala*
Species: ***A. tataricum***
Binomial name
Acer tataricum L. 1753
Synonyms[2]
List
▪ *Acer cordifolium* Moench
▪ *Euacer tataricum* (L.) Opiz

Description

Tatar maple near the central railway station in Helsinki, Finland.

Acer tataricum is a deciduous spreading shrub or small tree growing to 4–12 metres (13–39 ft) tall, with a short trunk up to 20–50 centimetres (7.9–19.7 in) diameter and slender branches. The bark is thin, pale brown, and smooth at first but becoming shallowly fissured on old plants. The leaves are opposite and simple, broadly ovate, 4.5–10 centimetres (1.8–3.9 in) long and 3–7 centimetres (1.2–2.8 in) broad, unlobed or with three or five shallow lobes, and matte green above; the leaf margin is coarsely and irregularly toothed; the leaf petiole is slender, often pink-tinged, 2–5 centimetres (0.79–1.97 in) long. The flowers are whitish-green, 5–8 millimetres (0.20–0.31 in) diameter, produced in spreading panicles in spring as the leaves open. The fruit is a paired reddish samara, 10–12 millimetres (0.39–0.47 in) long with a 2–3 centimetres (0.79–1.18 in) wing, maturing in late summer to early autumn.[3][4][5]

Taxonomy

Subspecies

subspecies accepted by the Plant List maintained by Kew Gardens in London.[5][6]

- *Acer tataricum* subsp. *aidzuense* (Franch.) P.C.DeJong
- *Acer tataricum* subsp. *ginnala* (Maxim.) Wesm. Japan, Korea, Mongolia, eastern Russia, northeastern and central China
- *Acer tataricum* subsp. *semenovii* (Regel & Herder) A.E.Murray - Tibet, Afghanistan, southern Russia, Iran
- *Acer tataricum* subsp. *tataricum* - Caucasus, Turkey, Austria, Hungary, Romania, Serbia, Ukraine
- *Acer tataricum* subsp. *theiferum* (W.P.Fang) Y.S.Chen & P.C.de Jong - China

- *Acer aidzuense* (Franch.) Nakai
- *Acer subintegrum* Pojark.
- *Acer ginnala* Maxim.
- *Acer theiferum* W.P.Fang
- *Acer semenovii* Regel & Herder

Some botanists treat *Acer tataricum* subsp. *ginnala* (Maxim.) Wesm. as a species *Acer ginnala* (Amur maple). Being closely related, they differ conspicuously in the glossy, deeply lobed leaves of *A. ginnala*, compared to the matte, unlobed or only shallowly lobed leaves of *A. tataricum*.[3]

Gallery

Leaf adaxial side.

Leaf abaxial side.

Leaf and fruit.

Leaf acer tataricum.

Cultivation and uses

Tatar maple is occasionally grown as an ornamental plant in gardens throughout Europe and also in North America. In Russia, it is valued in farmland shelterbelts.[4] It is locally naturalised in eastern North America.[3][7]

References

1. Crowley, D. (2018). "*Acer tataricum*" (https://www.iucnredlist.org/species/193877/2288126). *IUCN Red List of Threatened Species*. **2018**: e.T193877A2288126. doi:10.2305/IUCN.UK.2018-1.RLTS.T193877A2288126.en (https://doi.org/10.2305%2FIUCN.UK.2018-1.RLTS.T193877A2288126.en). Retrieved 16 November 2022.
2. The Plant List, *Acer tataricum* L. (http://www.theplantlist.org/tpl1.1/record/kew-2616524)
3. Rushforth, K. (1999). Trees of Britain and Europe. Collins. ISBN 978-0-00-220013-4.
4. Ecosystema: *Acer tataricum* (http://www.ecosystema.ru/08nature/trees/42.htm) (in Russian; google translation (https://translate.google.com/translate?hl=en&sl=ru&u=http://www.ecosystema.ru/08nature/trees/42.htm&sa=X&oi=translate&))
5. Flora of China, *Acer tataricum* Linnaeus, 1753. 鞑靼槭 da da qi (http://www.efloras.org/florataxon.aspx?flora_id=2&taxon_id=250084117)
6. "Acer tataricum L. — The Plant List" (http://www.theplantlist.org/tpl1.1/record/kew-2616524).
7. "*Acer tataricum*" (https://plants.usda.gov/java/profile?symbol=ACTA80). USDA Plant Profile. Retrieved October 9, 2007.

External links

- "Acer tataricum" (https://pfaf.org/user/Plant.aspx?LatinName=Acer+tataricum). *Plants for a Future*.
- photo of herbarium specimen at Missouri Botanical Garden (http://www.tropicos.org/ImageFullView.aspx?imageid=100171314)

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